Sarah L. Raman

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Education

B.A. Linguistics and French and Francophone Studies, *summa cum laude* June 2025
Carleton College Northfield, MN, USA

- *Senior Thesis (Linguistics):* The acquisition of L2 sociolinguistic competence: a repetition task approach to /l/-deletion in non-native French (with distinction)
- *Senior Thesis (French and Francophone Studies):* "Puisque nous t'aimons trop pour te retenir : nostalgie collective dans des spectacles d'hommage à Jean-Jacques Goldman [Because We Love You Too Much to Keep You: Collective Nostalgia in Tribute Concerts to Jean-Jacques Goldman]" (with distinction)
- *Relevant coursework:* Topics in Generative Syntax, Topics in Phonology, Sociophonetics, Sociolinguistic Field Methods, Cognitive Processes (with lab), Introduction to Psychology, Introduction to Computer Science, Education and Technology in the 21st Century

Visiting Students Programme, St. Catherine's College January 2024–June 2024
University of Oxford, Oxford, UK

Strasbourg Field Study and Internship Program August 2023–December 2023
Institute for Field Education, Strasbourg, France

- Coursework in French history and culture; linguistics research internship at the University of Strasbourg (conducted entirely in French)

Research and Teaching Experience

Project Coordinator Vanderbilt University, Nashville, TN January 2026–present
- Project Coordinator for the Communication and Language Lab (lab PI: Dr. Duane Watson)
- Coordinate an NSF-funded project on syntactic processing, reading experience, and individual cognitive differences (grant PI: Dr. Michelle Perdomo)
- Contribute to experimental design in jsPsych and Gorilla and analysis in RStudio
- Coordinate participant recruitment, study administration, and day-to-day financial operations
- Conduct independent research on relationship between AI use and grammatical preferences

French Teaching Assistant Carleton College, Northfield, MN March 2022–June 2025
- Taught bi-weekly French classes as sole instructor for levels 101-103
- Provided individual tutoring for students of all levels

Linguistics Teaching Assistant Carleton College, Northfield, MN September 2024–March 2025
- Attended class meetings, hosted tutoring hours, and facilitated group work for syntax classes
- Graded syntax problem sets

Research Intern University of Strasbourg, Strasbourg, France October 2024–December 2024

- Full-time intern at LiLPa (*linguistique, langue, parole*) lab (supervisor: Dr. Marie Lammert)
- Worked on multidisciplinary project analyzing discourse patterns in patients with acquired brain injuries
- Transcribed multi-hour interviews in French using ELAN and Express Scribe
- Conducted independent syntactic-prosodic research on the French left periphery in patients with acquired brain injuries (data collection using Sketch Engine; analysis in Praat and Prosogram), culminating in a thesis: "The Syntactic Status of Construction 'moi, je...' (me, I...), in Spoken French"

Student Research Partner Carleton College, Northfield, MN June 2023–July 2023

- Researched student attitudes towards digital tools for L2 vocabulary acquisition with Professor Sarah Anthony
- Conducted, transcribed, and coded semi-structured interviews
- Used Zotero to curate bibliography for a literature review

Grants and Awards

Summa cum laude Carleton College June 2025
Top 2% of class by GPA

Phi Beta Kappa Carleton College June 2025

Distinction in the Linguistics Major Carleton College June 2025
For achieving distinction in the Integrative Exercise (senior thesis) and having a major GPA above 3.50

Distinction in the French and Francophone Studies Major Carleton College June 2025
For achieving distinction in the Integrative Exercise (senior thesis) and having a major GPA above 3.50

Student Academic Grant Carleton College April 2025
$226 award to support travel to the Cornell Undergraduate Linguistics Conference

Senior Year Comps Fellowship Carleton College November 2024
$1938 travel award to conduct field research in France for my senior thesis in French and Francophone Studies

Student Academic Grant Carleton College November 2024
$524 award to support my senior thesis research in linguistics

Finalist, Award for Academic Achievement Abroad The Forum on Education Abroad November 2024
National award recognizing my research project, "The Syntactic Status of Construction 'moi, je...' (me, I...), in Spoken French," conducted at the University of Strasbourg

Dean's list Carleton College 2022-2023
Top 10% of class by previous year's GPA

Dean's list Carleton College 2021-2022
Top 10% of class by previous year's GPA

Presentations

Assessing sociolinguistic competence in L2 French (poster) October 2026
NWAV (New Ways of Analyzing Variation) 54, Montréal, QC

A repetition task approach to /l/-deletion in L2 French (poster) April 2025
19th Annual Cornell Undergraduate Linguistics Conference, Ithaca, NY

Collective Nostalgia in Tribute Performances to Jean-Jacques Goldman April 2025
Carleton French Comps (senior thesis) Presentation, Northfield, MN

A repetition task approach to /l/-deletion in L2 French March 2025
2025 Carleton Linguistics Comps Symposium, Northfield, MN

The Enigma of Jean-Jacques Goldman
2022 Pan-Lingua Undergraduate Conference on Languages & Cultures, Mankato, MN October 2022

Leadership experience

Business Manager and Staff Team Lead Concordia Language Villages July 2024–present (seasonal)
Leadership team for a French-immersion sleepaway camp

Student Departmental Advisor in Linguistics Carleton College September 2024–June 2025
Faculty-elected position

Student Departmental Advisor in French and Francophone Studies September 2024–June 2025
Carleton College
Faculty-elected position

Captain, Nova Ultimate Frisbee Team Carleton College September 2024–June 2025
Peer-elected position

Related employment

French Camp Counselor Concordia Language Villages, Bemidji, MN July 2019–present (seasonal)
- Design and lead activities to teach French language and francophone culture to campers ages 8–18

Tutor Self-employed, McLean, VA, Seattle, WA, and virtual September 2019–June 2021
- Provided one-on-one tutoring in French, Spanish, ESL, and math

Communications and Policy Intern JNCL-NCLIS, virtual December 2020–May 2021
- Interned for a language advocacy and lobby group on Capitol Hill

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Skills and interests

Language: French (advanced proficiency; Global Seal of Biliteracy), Spanish (intermediate proficiency)

Technical: R, Python, PsychoPy, Javascript, JsPsych, Praat, Elan, VARBRUL, Sketch Engine, Google Suite, Microsoft Suite, Canva, Zotero

Research skills: participant recruitment, sociolinguistic interviewing, stimulus design, acoustic analysis, transcription, copyediting and writing support, public speaking for both academic and general audiences

Interests: Crossword puzzles, specialty coffee, baseball, running, cycling, ultimate frisbee, travel writing

Updated November 10, 2026